



The Potato Paradox

Dehydrating potatoes from 99% water to 98% water results in a loss of half the total weight of the potatoes. <https://digit.in/sep18-68-1>



Supersnakes in the Everglades

A DNA study has indicated that Indian pythons mating with Burmese pythons would breed supersnakes. <https://digit.in/sep18-68-2>

T

aking the powerful force of human faith and turning it into a way to make money is highly prevalent

throughout the course of human history. Whether it be superstitions, or something else altogether, there's no shortage of people out there looking to employ a few tricks to fool the gullible to make a quick buck. These tricks prey on the human sentiment looking for the intervention of a higher power into solving their problems or granting them something of desire. Rather than the influence of a higher power, however, these tricks

the pit appears to be on fire, the central pathway on which the trickster will walk usually has coal that has been burning for a while. Additionally, spreading salt on the pathway helps attract moisture to the top layer from the atmosphere. Additionally, when coal cools down below the flash point, there's no new 'burning' happening. There's a reason that the trickster would usually walk slowly without running or jumping, as doing so would push the foot deeper into the pit, exposing the top of the foot to the trapped heat below. The sole has a large number of blood vessels and moisture that prevents the temperature of the foot from rising too much due

to the high specific heat of water at 4.184 kJ/K kg as well as the thermal conductivity of blood.

HAND IN MOLTEN METAL

Trick: Putting hand in molten lead without burning

Science: Leidenfrost effect

Explanation: This trick involves putting your hand into burning hot, molten lead without experiencing burning effects. This lead will usually be way above its melting point. This can be done because of something called the Leidenfrost effect. The hand is quickly dipped into water and then into the molten lead, where the heat from the

'Not so Super' superstitions

Science has been used to trick superstitious minds for ages

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are usually based on scientific principles, as well as a healthy dose of showmanship from the tricksters involved. While the intentions might even be noble, there's no doubt that knowing the truth behind these tricks can help people avoid being cheated out of their hard earned money. Here are some tricks commonly employed to fool people and the scientific basis behind them.

HEAT IMMUNITY

Trick: Walking on red hot coals

Science: Specific Heat and Thermal Conductivity

Explanation: Typically, such firewalks are conducted on coal pits prepared in advance, which allows the moisture in the coal to evaporate. Even if the rest of

